1. Introduction

Akemi Isles is a narrative exploration game where players travel across a chain of small islands, each filled with light platforming challenges, collectible items, and interactive environments. The game focuses on clarity, accessibility, and intuitive design. It is structured to guide players seamlessly from one environment to the next, one small challenge at a time.

This user manual provides step-by-step instructions for installing, running, and navigating Akemi Isles. It is written with new or non-technical users in mind, offering clear explanations, visuals (to be added later), and troubleshooting tips.

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2. System Requirements

Minimum Requirements

- **Operating System:** Windows 10 or later
- **Processor:** Intel i5 or equivalent
- **Memory:** 8 GB RAM
- **Graphics:** Integrated graphics (Intel UHD Graphics or better)
- **Storage:** 1 GB available space
- **Input:** Keyboard and mouse

Recommended Requirements

- **Processor:** Intel i7
- **Graphics:** Dedicated GPU (NVIDIA GTX 1050 or better)
- **Memory:** 16 GB RAM
- **Input:** Controller (optional)

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3. Installation Guide

3.1 Downloading the Game

1. Navigate to the provided download link (class submission folder or project page).
2. Download the file titled **AkemiIsles.zip**.

3.2 Installing

1. Locate the **AkemiIsles.zip** file in your Downloads folder.
2. Right-click the file and select **"Extract All…"**.
3. Choose a destination folder and click **Extract**.
4. After extraction, open the **AkemiIsles** folder.
5. Double-click **AkemiIsles.exe** to launch the game.

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4. Starting the Game

To start the game:

1. Navigate to the **AkemiIsles** installation folder.
2. Double-click **AkemiIsles.exe**.
3. The title screen will appear.
4. Click **"Play"** to begin

The game will load the first scene: **Island Beach**.

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5. Exiting the Game

To close the game:

1. Press **ESC** on your keyboard.
2. A pause menu will appear.
3. Click **“Quit Game”**.
4. Confirm when prompted.

Alternatively, close the window by clicking the **“X”** in the top-right corner of the window.

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6. Uninstalling the Game

Because Akemi Isles is a standalone application, uninstalling is simple:

1. Navigate to the folder where you extracted the game.
2. Select the entire **AkemiIsles** folder.
3. Right-click and choose **Delete**.

The game will be removed from your system.

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7. Game Overview

Akemi Isles is a **linear exploration and platforming game**. Players move across scenic island environments, solve simple traversal challenges, and collect items needed to progress.

The game’s flow is built around **moving forward**, exploring new scenes, and unlocking new environments using collected items.

While players may revisit earlier areas, some scenes will reset or trap the player if they attempt to backtrack. The intended experience is progression through each island toward the final scene.

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8. Controls & User Interface

8.1 Basic Controls

Action	Key
Move Left	A
Move Right	D
Jump	Spacebar
Interact / Use Item	Mouse Button 1
Pause Menu	Escape
Exit Game	Escape

8.2 Inventory System

Press the **inventory button** to open the inventory (top right of screen).

- Click an item to view details.
- If an item is usable, click **Use Item button** to apply its effect.
- Items automatically update quantities and disappear when used.

8.3 UI Elements

- **Scene Title:** Shows when entering a new island.
- **Inventory:** Shows picked up items, item data, and the use item button
- **Signs:** This will be replaced with actual NPC text in the future, but for the prototype we will only be using UI signs.

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9. Gameplay Features

9.1 Linear Exploration

Players progress from one island to the next. Most islands include:

- Platforming sections
- Light puzzles (in progress)
- Item-based progression

9.2 Collectible Items

Certain items are required to advance, such as:

- Keys
- Tools
- Special quest items

9.3 Interactable Objects

- Doors
- Bridges
- Shrines
- Chests

Press **E** to interact when prompted.

9.4 Platforming

Players may encounter:

- Moving platforms
- Gaps to jump over

- Elevation-based obstacles

9.5 Failure & Recovery

If players fall:

- They respawn at the nearest checkpoint.
- Inventory progress is preserved.

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10. Saving & Loading

Saving

As of now, there is no way to save the game as we are focusing on gameplay first. Eventually the game will save when:

- You enter a new island
- You pick up a major item
- You reach a checkpoint

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11. Troubleshooting

The game won't open.

- Right-click **AkemiIsles.exe → Run as Administrator**
- Restart your computer and try again

The player won't move.

- Check controller is not overriding keyboard input

The player gets stuck or falls through the map.

- If the issue persists, restart the game entirely

The game is laggy.

- Reduce window size
- Close unnecessary background programs
- Ensure your system meets minimum requirements

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12. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q: Can I change the controls?

Not in the alpha version. Control customization may be added in a future update.

Q: Does the game have multiple endings?

No — Akemi Isles follows a linear narrative and a single ending.

Q: Can I revisit previous islands?

Yes, but certain scenes may lock the player from progressing backward depending on the design.

Q: Is there combat?

No. This game focuses on exploration and light platforming.

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13. Support & Contact Information

If you encounter issues, have questions, or would like to provide feedback, contact:

Matthew De Jesus
Email: mdejesu4@lion.lmu.edu

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14. Glossary

Alpha Version – Early build of the game containing core features but not final polish.
Checkpoint – Location where the game autosaves progress.
Inventory – A menu showing items the player has collected.
Interactable – An object in the game world the player can use or activate.
Linear Level Design – A structure where players move through scenes in a specific order.
NPC – Non-Player Character (if applicable in future updates).

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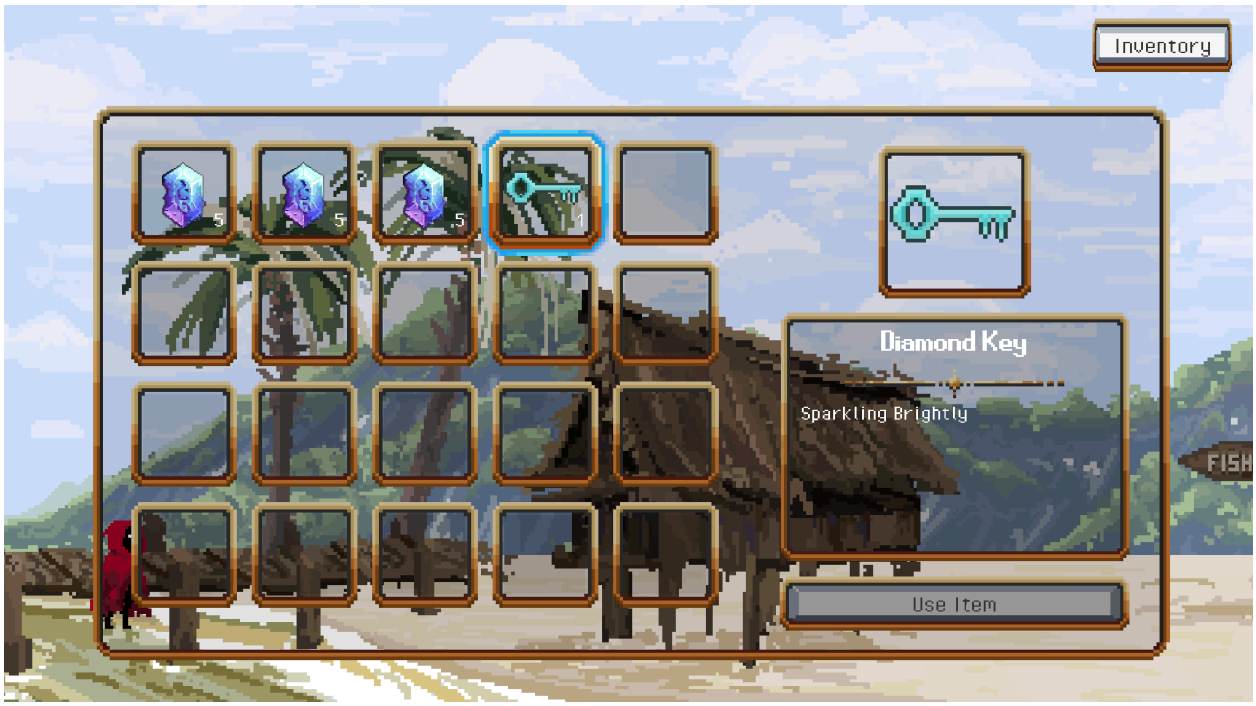
15. Appendix A: Screenshots

- Title Screen

- Island Beach (starting area)

- Inventory UI